



Using Live Preview

making it easier for the user to choose a desirable effect. For example, rather than displaying the possible colours for a table, the gallery displays the table in various colours.

formatting option will reflect the change in the content. This removes the need for undoing any applied changes if one is not satisfied.

Conceptually similar to the Live Preview feature is Gallery, a feature that rather than merely listing the name of an effect, graphically displays its sample application,



Using the Gallery

While the emphasis of the UI is to make it easier for newcomers to work with the application, veterans will not be put off, since the same shortcut combinations are usable. If needed the ribbon can be switched off, to maximise viewing area, by double-clicking on any tab.

1.2.4 Internal Changes

Besides the changes in the interface, the computational limits of Excel have been pushed further. The number of rows and columns have been increased to 1048576 and 16384 respectively. Contrast this with the earlier limits of 65536 rows and 256 columns. To be able to handle this larger spreadsheet, MS Office now is able to use up all the RAM supported by the OS (4 GB in case of a 32-bit OS; specifically, in Excel, there is a 2 GB limit), compared to the previous maximum of 1 GB. And the software has also been optimised or multi-threaded to make better use of multi-core CPUs. Under certain circumstances, as mentioned at <http://blogs.msdn.com/excel/archive/2005/11/03/488822.aspx> (<http://tinyurl.com/2lv88a>), this allows Excel 2007 to complete a task twice as fast as the previous version. Other enhancements include the increase in the number of characters a cell can